When Group Gets Stuck

Printable Card Pack

39 quick-reference cards, the Safety first page, and your program-routes page.

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Safety first

Use this page before any card when safety may be in question. It does not replace your program's crisis, emergency, or medical procedures; it helps you recognize when to use them. Scenarios 33 to 36 walk through four of these situations in detail.

Stop routine teaching when you notice

- **Statements of possible danger:** for example, “I don't know whether I can get through tonight,” talk of wanting to die or of not being safe, or a threat toward someone else.
- **A change in awareness:** new confusion, difficulty staying awake or being roused, slurred speech, unsteadiness, or signs of possible intoxication or overdose.
- **A possible physical emergency:** chest pain, trouble breathing, unusually slow breathing, fainting, or a seizure.
- **A report of current danger:** someone describes being unsafe now or having nowhere safe to go tonight.

Then, in every scenario

- **Stay with the group.** Never leave it unattended, and never send a member to escort, find, monitor, or interpret for anyone.
- **Request help now** through your program's route. If nobody answers, use the backup route; an unanswered call or message is not a handoff.
- **Keep private details private.** Do not ask about plans, history, or symptoms in front of the group.
- **Do not finish the lesson first,** and do not let the end of the session close the response. Ask the person to stay with you until staff connect, unless your program's procedure directs otherwise.
- **For a medical emergency,** follow your program's emergency procedure, including calling emergency services when that is the local instruction.
- **In a video group,** stay in the meeting with your camera on and use the member's confirmed location and backup phone number.
- **If anyone is in immediate physical danger,** use your program's emergency procedure at once. Your role is to get help, not to restrain anyone.

In the United States, the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (call or text 988) is available 24/7. It supports, but does not replace, your program's response.

When you request help, say

Who you are and where you are; what you observed and what was said; where the person is now; what you need; and that you are staying with the group.

My program's routes

Help during group: _____

Backup if no answer: _____

Emergency procedure: _____

Medication questions: _____

Language services: _____

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Standalone quick reference

When one member needs more time

Scenario 1 | Adult IOP | DBT STOP

Notice

Ten minutes into check-in, Jordan has spoken rapidly for four minutes about a housing and family conflict. Others are waiting. No overt threat has been stated; safety still requires attention.

First response

“Jordan, that sounds like a hard night. I'm pausing the details so everyone has time. Would you like to ask for a staff check-in without sharing details, or listen for now?”

Choose the next step

- **Engages:** Offer private practice, a fictional example, or observation.
- **Objects or mentions housing:** Acknowledge the impact. Clarify urgency through the program's support route; practical help and clinical assessment are different responses. Do not postpone an immediate need for the lesson.
- **Peers offer advice:** “Let's hold peer advice to protect Jordan's privacy and everyone's check-in time.”
- **Goes quiet:** Offer listening and a feasible check-in; silence does not establish improvement.
- **Possible harm or medical concern:** Pause routine redirection and use local assessment or emergency procedures.

Return to STOP

Confirm a feasible support step suited to the urgency before routine practice; the housing issue need not be resolved in the room. Use a separate heated-message example: Stop, Take a step back, Observe, Proceed mindfully. Pause before sending, notice the urge, and choose an action that fits the goal. Stepping back need not mean leaving. Practice is not a condition for receiving help.

Support and record

Coordinate private support and coverage with a co-facilitator. Alone, stay with the group and request staff help; never leave it unattended. Promise only available follow-up. Record actual support and participation, distinguishing observation from practice.

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Standalone quick reference

Nobody answers the opening question

Scenario 2 | Adult IOP | DBT Describe

Notice

Nobody answers a broad question about the previous session. Two members are new. Thinking, an unclear prompt, access needs, or a participation choice are possibilities; the cause is unknown.

First response

“I asked two things and referred to a previous session without giving the context. Let's use a small example. Nobody needs a personal story, and I won't call around the room.”

Choose the next step

- **Someone responds:** Acknowledge the specific contribution; do not ask them to explain everyone's silence.
- **Still quiet:** Contrast A, “The cup is beside the notebook,” with B, “Someone left it there because they don't care.” Invite an A or B response, an indicated choice, or private consideration. Responding and writing remain optional.
- **Access barrier:** Adapt the example or mode and check whether it helps. Do not assume everyone can see the cup.
- **Interpersonal concern:** Address reported harm before using practice to move on.
- **Changed awareness or responsiveness:** Use local assessment and response procedures. Ordinary quiet alone is different.

Return to Describe

Model putting words to a noticed feature without adding motives. Invite another description, private practice, or observation. A thought can be labeled as a thought without disproving it. Do not keep repeating the prompt to pressure an answer.

Support and record

Coordinate any individual support and group coverage with a co-facilitator. Alone, stay with the group and request staff help as needed; never leave it unattended. Arrange feasible follow-up. Record observed responses; private practice and its effects remain unconfirmed without further information.

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Standalone quick reference

A disagreement becomes personal

Scenario 3 | Adult IOP | DBT GIVE

Notice

Alex labels Morgan during a disagreement. Morgan objects; speech overlaps. Interrupt the attack without assigning equal blame to the insult and the response.

First response

“Alex, I'm stopping the personal comment. You can disagree with the suggestion without labeling Morgan. Morgan, you don't need to defend yourself or explain more.”

Choose the next step

- **Label withdrawn:** Morgan may speak about the topic, listen, or request support. Do not declare repair complete.
- **Defends it:** Offer listening or disagreement about the strategy without a personal label.
- **Repeats the attack:** Pause discussion and request staff support. Avoid debating the label.
- **Peers take sides:** “Hold on. I'm addressing this. We won't ask the group to judge either person.”
- **Morgan goes quiet:** Offer feasible support without requiring reassurance or mediation.
- **Threat or significant clinical change:** Use local assessment or emergency procedures.

Return to GIVE

Resume only when attacks have stopped and support needs have been addressed. GIVE does not require tolerating mistreatment or staying in an unsafe relationship. Introduce Gentle, Interested, Validate, and Easy manner using colleagues who disagree about an agenda. Model acknowledgment and curiosity. Do not replay the members' conflict.

Support and record

Coordinate individual support and coverage with a co-facilitator. Alone, stay with the group and request staff help; never leave it unattended. If hostility continues, stop debating, update responding staff through the available route, and follow local escalation procedures. Do not delay assessment. Record actual conduct and support in each member's record without identifying peers.

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Standalone quick reference

A member declines the activity

Scenario 4 | Adult IOP | DBT Check the Facts

Notice

Riley declines a personal worksheet and questions disclosure and invalidation. Refusal alone does not establish unwillingness to learn or require removal.

First response

“I hear concerns about privacy and feeling dismissed. You don't need to tell us the story. Checking facts looks at what is known and uncertain; it isn't meant to deny what happened. Let me explain what happens to written pages.”

State the program's actual collection and retention arrangements.

Choose the next step

- **Accepts another route:** Use a fictional example without required writing. Invite one contribution or listening.
- **Still declines:** Clarify once and respect the answer. Review unresolved participation questions separately under program procedures.
- **Others also object:** Explain the same available alternatives without asking peers to persuade Riley.
- **Access barrier:** Offer a feasible adaptation and check that it helps; do not promise unavailable materials.
- **Current harm or clinical change:** Take reported harm seriously rather than arguing it away; pause the exercise for support, local assessment, or emergency procedures as indicated.

Return to Check the Facts

Use an instructor moving an unfinished bowl. The fictional participant feels ashamed and anxious and anticipates rejection. Separate the action from the interpretation. Examine missing facts, other explanations, and evidence of exclusion. Consider likelihood, coping, and whether the emotions and their intensity fit what is known. Avoid invented reassurance.

Support and record

Coordinate individual support and coverage with a co-facilitator. Alone, stay with the group and request staff help as needed; never leave it unattended. Record actual choices, adaptations, contributions, and follow-up. Listening does not demonstrate mastery.

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Standalone quick reference

A new member joins midway through the cycle

Scenario 5 | Adult IOP | DBT Problem Solving

Notice

Sam arrives at the session's beginning but lacks context from earlier lessons. Lee wants application time. A lesson introduction does not replace essential admission or consent preparation.

First response

“Sam, I referred to yesterday without explaining today's task. That's on me. Lee, we'll also keep time for applying it. I'll show the starting point.”

Choose the next step

- **Finds an entry point:** Acknowledge the specific contribution; it does not establish full orientation or mastery.
- **Still unclear:** Simplify to one task, model accessibly, and arrange feasible teaching support. Observation remains an option.
- **Returning member objects:** Offer starting and application tasks to everyone. Do not rank members or ask peers to teach Sam.
- **Essential preparation gap:** Use the program's preparation process before sensitive participation. Obtain missing admission information through staff.
- **Significant clinical concern:** Use local assessment or emergency procedures with appropriate support and coverage. Basic questions alone are different.

Return to Problem Solving

Use an appointment reminder with no address. Identify the situation, check the facts, define the goal, generate options, compare and select one, implement it, and review the result. Consider access to a letter, phone, or other channel. If a phone line disconnects, find another feasible route rather than blaming effort.

Support and record

Coordinate any individual explanation and group coverage with a co-facilitator. Alone, stay with the group and arrange staff support through the established route; never leave it unattended. Confirm follow-up responsibility and timing. Record demonstrated understanding and actual arrangements without inferring readiness.

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Standalone quick reference

The facilitator makes a harmful assumption

Scenario 6 | Adult IOP | DBT Validation

Notice

You linked Casey's unfinished practice page with not caring about recovery. Correct the assumption even without an objection. Quiet does not establish repair.

First response

“Casey, I assumed an unfinished page meant you didn't care. That was unfair, and I'm sorry. You don't need to explain your circumstances.”

Choose the next step

- **Names the impact:** Reflect accurately, acknowledge your conduct, and change the invitation. Do not request forgiveness.
- **Remains distrustful:** Describe what will change and offer the program's actual feedback or alternative staff route. Confirm availability before promising contact.
- **A peer defends you:** “Intention doesn't undo what I said. Casey doesn't need to agree that it was harmless.”
- **Goes quiet:** Offer a feasible check-in once; do not require reassurance.
- **Possible harm or medical concern:** Use local assessment or emergency procedures with coverage. Criticism alone is different.

Return to Validation

Ask, “Was the task useful, or did something get in the way?” Personal circumstances need not be disclosed. If appropriate, use a separate friend disappointed by a canceled event. Listen and reflect what was said; check accuracy without inventing feelings or history. Validation need not endorse every conclusion. Do not use Casey's experience as the demonstration or treat resuming as proof of repair.

Support and record

Coordinate support and coverage with a co-facilitator. Alone, stay with the group and request staff assistance; never leave it unattended. Promise only available follow-up. Seek supervision. Record your own conduct and the member's actual response, including unresolved concerns.

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Standalone quick reference

A member repeatedly interrupts

Scenario 7 | Adult IOP | DBT One Mindfully

Notice

Taylor starts speaking before several members finish. Restore access to turns without guessing intent or asking peers to manage Taylor.

First response

“Taylor, you have something to add. Let me hear the end of this turn, then I'll come to you.”

Ask the interrupted speaker whether they want to finish or pass. Keep the place in the sequence you promised Taylor.

Choose the next step

- **Uses the cue:** Invite the contribution when promised. A note is optional, not required.
- **Overlaps again:** Restate the current turn once, clarify a usable cue, and change the format if needed. Do not debate whose idea came first.
- **A peer criticizes:** Manage turns yourself; stop personal labels and restore the affected speaker's choice.
- **Discussion remains unworkable:** Pause the open exchange. Use available support and local participation procedures, not automatic removal.
- **Possible harm or clinical change:** Pause teaching for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the exercise first.

Return to One Mindfully

Confirm an understandable order and an opportunity to finish or pass. Use a separate folder-assembly example: notice switching to an unrelated shopping list and return attention to the current step. Offer an accessible task or observation; silence is not mastery.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate private support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request staff help. Do not leave the group unattended. Record actual interruptions, cues, responses, and confirmed or pending follow-up without naming peers.

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Standalone quick reference

Advice takes over another member's turn

Scenario 8 | Adult IOP | DBT Validation

Notice

Nia gives directives before Miles asks for ideas. Others add solutions; Miles stops speaking. Do not infer consent or require an explanation of private circumstances.

First response

“I hear people wanting to help. Let's pause the solutions. Miles, would you like us to listen, or would you rather leave it there?”

Choose the next step

- **Wants listening:** Invite an optional reflection of what was actually said. Check accuracy without adding a solution.
- **Advice continues:** State the boundary once and stop the advice exchange. Do not debate whether quitting work is wise.
- **Wants ideas:** Clarify scope, invite brief relevant experiences, and permit stopping. Do not endorse clinical or other instructions outside your role.
- **Goes quiet or requests support:** Offer listening or a feasible staff check-in without requiring personal details.
- **Possible harm or clinical change:** Pause teaching for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the activity first.

Return to Validation

Stop unsolicited directives and address requested support before resuming. Use a separate fictional neighbor disappointed about a full community garden. Attend, reflect the stated experience, and check accuracy. Understanding does not require endorsing every conclusion. Offer practice or observation.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request staff help; never leave it unattended. Promise only available follow-up. Record the individual's actual contribution and response without identifying peers; distinguish requested from confirmed follow-up.

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Standalone quick reference

A member cannot use the worksheet

Scenario 9 | Adult PHP | DBT Describe

Notice

Avery reports that the page is unusable. Do not label this refusal or ask for a diagnosis, reading history, or public demonstration of difficulty.

First response

“The page isn't working for you. I'll explain the task aloud. You can answer out loud, try it privately, or watch.”

Stop peers from examining the page or taking over uninvited.

Choose the next step

- **Oral route helps:** Model one step and invite an optional contribution. Give feedback on what is demonstrated.
- **Still unclear:** Change the explanation or format; do not repeat it louder. Check your explanation without testing Avery publicly.
- **Access remains unresolved:** Arrange appropriate staff support and an actually available option. Do not claim that watching an inaccessible model meets the need.
- **Sudden visual or cognitive change, possible harm, or medical concern:** Pause teaching for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the example first.

Return to Describe

Confirm a usable entry or an appropriate support step. Use a separate folded-towel example: describe an uneven edge rather than infer carelessness. Adapt the object or sensory route without requiring touch, reading, or writing. An oral detail can show one step; private practice remains unobserved.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate private clarification and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request help; never leave it unattended. PHP does not guarantee immediate backup. Record reported needs, actual formats, responses, and pending arrangements without diagnosing their cause.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), mindfulness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

Access source: AHRQ, Health Literacy Universal Precautions Toolkit, Tool 5. AHRQ Tool 5

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Standalone quick reference

A tired member struggles with the lesson

Scenario 10 | Adult PHP | DBT Observe

Notice

Parker reports exhaustion and difficulty with several steps. Do not assume a cause. Answering a question does not rule out a clinical concern.

First response

“Parker, I hear that you're exhausted. Do you need staff help now, or would a simpler way to take part be useful?”

Do not require public health details. Emergency action takes priority over this question.

Choose the next step

- **Smaller task fits:** Offer one accessible step without writing, or observation. Continue attending to changes.
- **Feels unwell or requests help:** Use the clinical assessment route promptly; another practice attempt is not required.
- **Medication question:** Connect with the appropriate clinician; do not advise dose changes.
- **Peers judge effort:** Stop the comparison without disclosing private information.
- **New confusion, difficult to rouse, slurred speech, unsteadiness, or unusually slow breathing:** Stop teaching and activate local emergency procedures immediately. Do not finish the activity or wait for a break.

Return to Observe

Address indicated assessment and confirm support before routine teaching resumes. Choosing to listen does not justify delay. Use a separate cabinet-light example with an accessible sensory alternative; no closed eyes, breathing change, or movement is required. Practice does not establish medical fitness.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support, supervision, and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request help; never leave it unattended. Use local escalation if help is delayed. Confirm handoff responsibility. Record actual observations, reported practice, requests, and pending responses.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), mindfulness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

Safety source: MedlinePlus, Confusion. MedlinePlus Confusion

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Standalone quick reference

Silence after a painful disclosure

Scenario 11 | Adult IOP | DBT Validation

Notice

Quinn shares a recent loss, then interprets silence as rejection. Do not assume what the silence means or demand personal reactions from peers.

First response

“Quinn, I'm sorry to hear about your brother. You don't need to make this easier for us. Would you like us to listen, or stop here?”

Choose the next step

- **Wants acknowledgment:** Reflect the stated meaning and check accuracy. Honor a request to stop.
- **Feels rejected:** Acknowledge the impact without claiming to know everyone's feelings. Invite an optional response only if wanted.
- **Peers explain or compare losses:** Stop explanations and protect disclosure choices. Do not turn the moment into compulsory sharing.
- **Requests support:** Confirm a feasible staff route and its timing; do not promise unavailable contact.
- **Possible harm or clinical change:** Pause teaching for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish a reflection exercise first.

Return to Validation

Acknowledge the disclosure and address immediate support needs before resuming. Use a separate canceled-choir example. Reflect what was said, check accuracy, and offer practice or observation. Quinn's grief is not the demonstration.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate private support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Do not require private details. Record the actual preference, intervention, and confirmed or pending contact.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), interpersonal-effectiveness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Language support does not meet the task

Scenario 12 | Adult PHP | DBT Describe

Notice

The arranged interpreter connection fails. Drew reports not understanding. A peer's offer and conversational English do not establish usable clinical communication.

First response

Through a working communication route: “The connection failed. I need to fix how the instructions reach you. You don't need to explain personal information to the group.” If no qualified route is working, give only a brief, simple message that you are restoring the interpreter; no clinical instructions and no peer interpreting.

Choose the next step

- **Qualified support reconnects:** Confirm arrangements, address Drew directly, use short segments, and check one instruction.
- **Still unusable:** Request backup language services. Do not count watching an unintelligible model as equivalent access.
- **Peer volunteers:** Thank them; use the program's qualified route rather than assigning a patient to interpret.
- **Drew prefers peer help:** Acknowledge the preference and consult the appropriate access process; do not improvise an exception.
- **Possible harm or sudden clinical change:** Use local assessment or emergency procedures immediately as indicated, requesting language support alongside the response. Do not wait for the worksheet or connection.

Return to Describe

Confirm usable communication or an appropriate alternative. Use a separate envelope example: describe its exterior without guessing its contents. Offer supported practice or an accessible model without requiring private material.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate access support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Record actual language support, responses, unresolved limits, and handoff responsibility.

Sources: Linehan (2015), mindfulness teaching notes; AHRQ, Tool 9. AHRQ language access

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Standalone quick reference

Check-in has used the practice time

Scenario 13 | Adult IOP | DBT One Mindfully

Notice

Only twelve minutes remain. Own the timing and revise the plan without blaming the last speaker or racing through every slide.

First response

“We've spent longer on check-in than I planned. I want to protect time for a useful practice and a proper close.”

Choose the next step

- **Smaller objective fits:** Name one step, offer brief practice or observation, and retain closing time.
- **Member objects:** Acknowledge lost practice time and identify a change within your authority. Do not defend the whole session.
- **Additional topic can wait:** Confirm an available route and what remains pending; do not invent follow-up.
- **Possible urgent need (for example, “I don't know whether I can get through tonight”):** Thank them, request staff now, and ask them to stay until staff connect. Do not ask for details in front of the group. The end of check-in or the session is not a reason to delay. Do not finish practice first.

Return to One Mindfully

Address immediate needs and explain what will be omitted. Use a separate library-announcement example: notice a shift to meal planning and return to the current message. Offer an accessible format. Writing and reporting personal material are optional. Do not treat observing as confirmed practice.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate individual support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Confirm handoff responsibility. Record actual content, reported or observed responses, and pending arrangements rather than the original agenda.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), mindfulness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

A comment targets identity

Scenario 14 | Adult IOP | DBT Validation

Notice

Terry invalidates same-sex families after Robin mentions a partner. Stop the conduct without treating Robin's objection as equivalent harm.

First response

“Robin, you don't need to defend your family. Terry, that comment dismissed same-sex families, and I'm stopping it.”

Choose the next step

- **Statement withdrawn:** Offer Robin listening or feasible support. No response, thanks, or forgiveness is required.
- **Belief debate begins:** Restate the conduct boundary once; do not debate whose identity or family is legitimate.
- **Comment repeats:** Pause teaching and request staff support through local procedures. Do not improvise expulsion.
- **Peers defend intent:** Return to the conduct and support needs without compulsory identity disclosures.
- **Threat, possible harm, or clinical change:** Use local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the skill exercise first.

Return to Validation

Stop the conduct, acknowledge impact, and address requested support before teaching resumes. Use a separate overlooked-volunteer example. Reflect the stated experience and check accuracy; Robin's experience is not a required practice task for Terry.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate individual support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Confirm follow-up responsibility. Record individual conduct and actual responses without identifying peers. A retraction does not establish repair.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), interpersonal-effectiveness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Laughter interrupts a contribution

Scenario 15 | Adult PHP | DBT Check the Facts

Notice

Finley stops speaking after peers laugh. The interruption is observable; its intended target is uncertain. Take the impact seriously.

First response

“Finley, the laughter interrupted you. You don't have to continue your example.”

“Please stop the side conversation. We need one speaker.”

Choose the next step

- **Aside stops:** Offer finishing, passing, listening, or feasible support. No acceptance of an explanation or apology is required.
- **Intent is disputed:** Hear a brief account without debating Finley's feelings or demanding private messages as evidence.
- **Disruption continues:** Pause teaching and use local conduct and support procedures.
- **Member wants to leave:** Say you're requesting support; do not block or follow. Stay with the group and use the Scenario 29 steps.
- **Threat, urgent harm, or clinical change:** Pause for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not complete the worksheet first.

Return to Check the Facts

Resume only after the interruption stops and support requests have a workable response. Use a separate rain-forecast example to distinguish information from prediction. Do not use the skill to argue away actual harm.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and room coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Record the individual's statements, choices, and actual response without peer identities. Confirm follow-up responsibility; quietness does not establish repair.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), emotion-regulation teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Members question a boundary's fairness

Scenario 16 | Adult IOP | DBT DEAR MAN

Notice

Devon questions check-in timing; peers join in. A legitimate concern and overlapping speech can occur together.

First response

“You're questioning whether I applied the time limit evenly. I want to hear that without several people having to compete.”

Choose the next step

- **Clear error:** Own it and offer a feasible correction. Do not promise time you cannot provide.
- **Unresolved comparison:** Clarify current turns and the review route. Confirm who will follow up and when.
- **Overlapping speech:** Restore one speaker; pause teaching and request support if disruptive conduct continues.
- **Private comparisons requested:** Explain the general process without discussing another member's circumstances.
- **Threat, urgent harm, or clinical change:** Stop for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the exercise first.

Return to DEAR MAN

Resume after clarifying the limit and responding to the concern or arranging review. Use a separate choir member's request for written rehearsal details to practice selected DEAR MAN steps: Describe, Assert, Reinforce. A polished request is not required before a complaint can be heard.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, stay with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Do not debate each angry statement or demand private explanations. Record the individual's concern, actual correction, and pending review without peer identities. Silence does not establish agreement.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), interpersonal-effectiveness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Peers ask for graphic details

Scenario 17 | Adult IOP | DBT STOP

Notice

Harper mentions a painful event; peers ask for details. Interrupt the pressure without implying that the experience cannot be acknowledged.

First response

“Harper, you don't need to describe what happened for us to take your experience seriously.”

“Please stop asking for details. Harper doesn't owe the group that account.”

Choose the next step

- **Wants to listen:** Honor the choice and agree on a usable support signal.
- **Wants a full account now:** Explain the format boundary and arrange an appropriate individual support route. Do not promise a treatment outcome.
- **Peers persist:** Restate the limit once. No debate, compulsory reassurance, or shared-trauma round.
- **Concerning clinical change or urgent harm:** Pause for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not assume grounding is sufficient or finish the worksheet first.

Return to STOP

Resume only after detail-seeking stops and current support needs have a workable response. Use a separate ticket-machine frustration. A step back can be a pause in place; it does not require leaving. Do not make the disclosed event the practice task.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Confirm receipt and responsibility before describing a handoff as complete. Record actual choices and actions without unnecessary trauma details or peer identities.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), distress-tolerance teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Diagnosis or medication advice is requested

Scenario 18 | Adult PHP | DBT DEAR MAN

Notice

Ellis reports feeling “wired” after a medication change and asks about diagnosis and the next dose. Treat the report as a clinical concern, not merely an off-topic question.

First response

“That change matters. I can't decide a diagnosis or dose here. I'm contacting the appropriate clinical staff.”

Choose the next step

- **Help available:** Coordinate an individual review and confirm who accepts responsibility. Protect private details.
- **Usual contact unavailable:** Use the backup clinical route and local escalation plan; do not simply defer to a routine appointment. Before Ellis leaves, confirm who will answer the dose question tonight and how to reach them.
- **Peers give instructions:** Stop advice about changing or sharing medication. Do not debate treatments.
- **Significant clinical change or possible urgent harm:** Pause for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish a worksheet or test the skill first.

Return to DEAR MAN

Resume only when the current care response and coverage permit. Use a separate request for a written repair estimate. A well-worded request is not a prerequisite for clinical attention. This card gives no individualized instruction to take, skip, or change a dose.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Record the report, actual contact, and confirmed or pending handoff without peer histories. Do not infer cause or diagnosis.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), interpersonal-effectiveness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

A guarantee is requested

Scenario 19 | Adult IOP | DBT Pros and Cons

Notice

Jesse asks for certain relief; a peer attributes success to effort. Answer honestly and stop the pressure.

First response

“You're looking for something that will help tonight. I can't promise how you'll feel after using this.”

“We won't judge another person's effort or guarantee their result.”

Choose the next step

- **Chooses to observe:** Honor the choice without requiring belief or an endorsement.
- **Earlier claim was inflated:** Correct it directly; do not replace it with another guarantee.
- **Demands certainty again:** Restate the limit briefly and offer the task or support route. Do not debate each objection.
- **Practical need identified:** Arrange the appropriate support route; worksheet completion is not a condition for help.
- **Urgent harm or clinical change:** Pause for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the exercise first.

Return to Pros and Cons

Resume after clarifying the learning aim and addressing current support needs. Use a separate parcel-complaint example to consider immediate and later consequences. No private history is required, and instant relief is not promised.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Record actual choices, the member's report of benefit or no benefit, and confirmed or pending follow-up without peer identities.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), distress-tolerance teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

“We've done this already”

Scenario 20 | Adult IOP | DBT Effectively

Notice

Returning members question repetition; a newcomer withdraws. Check the concern without ranking members by experience.

First response

“You've heard this before, and you want the time to be useful. I'll explain what is repeated and what can be different.”

Choose the next step

- **Wants more challenge:** Offer a manageable fictional application with competing goals, not extra busywork.
- **Questions the schedule:** Explain what you know, correct an actual error, and confirm any promised review.
- **Starts instructing peers:** Restore one speaker. No compulsory teaching, comparisons, or debate about expertise.
- **Needs the basics:** Keep the explanation available without requiring attendance or private-history disclosures.
- **Urgent harm or clinical change:** Pause for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the task first.

Return to Effectively

Resume with one shared aim and two supervised entry points. Use the borrowed-chair examples to compare actions with a chosen goal. Effectiveness is not obedience or a guaranteed outcome. Observation remains available.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate task support and coverage. Alone, keep both options within the group you can supervise; never leave members or a subgroup unattended. Request assistance for individual support. Record actual task responses and confirmed or pending review without peer identities. Familiarity is not mastery.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), mindfulness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Arrivals and departures interrupt teaching

Scenario 21 | Adult PHP | DBT STOP

Notice

Dana arrives during a demonstration while another member is called out. Multiple recaps begin. Address coordination and access without assigning blame.

First response

“Welcome, Dana. You don't need to explain the arrival here.”

“Please hold the recaps. I'll give the current instruction; we won't repeat personal examples.”

Choose the next step

- **Brief entry:** Offer observation or the next fictional practice and an accessible task prompt.
- **Scheduled departure:** Confirm the receiving staff member and actual transition arrangement through the established process.
- **Repeated traffic:** Pause teaching and coordinate support; do not restart private check-ins.
- **Criticism begins:** Hear the scheduling concern without demanding private reasons or debating accommodations.
- **Urgent harm or clinical change:** Stop for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the worksheet first.

Return to STOP

Resume after responsibility, current-task access, and coverage are clear. Use a separate replacement-bulb frustration. A step back can be a pause in place; it does not require leaving. Nobody's arrival or appointment becomes practice material.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate transitions and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended or send a peer as staff escort. Record actual entry and participation without peer histories. Do not infer full attendance or completed assessment.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), distress-tolerance teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Membership changes unexpectedly

Scenario 22 | Adult PHP | DBT Validation

Notice

Rory expected a familiar practice partner. The person is absent; peers speculate. This card addresses membership uncertainty, not a live walkout.

First response

“You expected to practice together. I can't share another person's care or plans, but I can explain today's options and support route.”

Choose the next step

- **Needs a task option:** Offer supervised observation, a fictional demonstration, or a feasible pairing. No immediate replacement relationship is required.
- **Questions continue:** Restate the privacy boundary briefly; do not debate or imply a private reason.
- **Outreach proposed:** Do not organize contact, share details, or recruit peers to investigate. Use the program's actual boundaries.
- **Wants support:** Request appropriate staff contact and confirm responsibility.
- **Urgent harm or clinical change:** Pause for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish an exercise first.

Return to Validation

Resume after stopping speculation, clarifying task arrangements, and addressing current support needs. Use a separate changed-walking-routine example. Nobody must disclose a personal loss, speculate about motives, or announce closure.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, stay with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Record the present individual's statements and choices without identifying the absent member or speculating about care. A request is not a completed handoff.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), interpersonal-effectiveness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Practice increases distress

Scenario 23 | Adult IOP | DBT Observe

Notice

Ash says body-focused attention makes distress worse and asks to stop. Honor the request before explaining the method.

First response

“Yes, we're stopping. You don't need to keep focusing on your chest.”

“Please don't coach Ash to continue.”

Choose the next step

- **Wants to listen:** Allow listening without another exercise or a private-history explanation.
- **Wants an alternative:** Offer a brief neutral external observation only if acceptable. Stop if unwanted or unhelpful; no endurance target.
- **Chest pain, trouble breathing, or feeling faint:** Treat as a possible medical emergency and use local emergency procedures now.
- **Wants support:** Use the established staff route and confirm who receives responsibility.
- **Significant clinical change or urgent harm:** Stop for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not assume panic or dissociation, finish the worksheet, or try grounding first as a requirement.

Return to Observe

Resume only after ending the original practice and responding to current needs. Demonstrate noticing a clothespin without compulsory touch or internal focus. Do not promise calming. Observation of the demonstration or declining it remains available.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended or assign peers to monitor Ash. Record the report, stop request, choices, and actual or pending contact without inferred diagnoses or peer histories. Quietness is not assessment or proof of improvement.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), mindfulness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

The room is difficult to tolerate

Scenario 24 | Adult PHP | DBT Observe

Notice

Screen flicker and corridor noise interfere with participation. Address the environment before turning discomfort into a practice task.

First response

“I'm pausing the instructions while we address what we can. You don't need to explain a diagnosis.”

Choose the next step

- **Controllable barrier:** Reduce it and provide an accessible current prompt. Check what remains difficult.
- **Space still unsuitable:** Keep teaching paused and coordinate staff support. Confirm destination, access, and supervision before moving.
- **Different access needs:** Explore concrete options without a group vote on legitimacy or compulsory medical disclosure.
- **Peers prescribe endurance:** Stop the pressure; do not debate normal tolerance.
- **Clinical change, urgent harm, or environmental emergency:** Use local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the worksheet first. Closing a door is fine; never lock or obstruct an exit.

Return to Observe

Resume only when the task is usable and current support needs are addressed. Offer a separate paper-windmill demonstration with a spoken description. No compulsory touch, closed eyes, or attention to distressing noise; no promise of relief.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate environmental support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended to find another room. Record the member's report, actual changes, remaining barriers, and pending arrangements without peer histories or inferred diagnoses.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), mindfulness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

A suggestion does not fit real constraints

Scenario 25 | Adult PHP | DBT Problem Solving

Notice

The suggested home practice assumes private time and space that Blair lacks. Acknowledge the mismatch before offering more advice.

First response

“My suggestion assumed resources you said you don't have. That doesn't fit your situation.”

“We can use a fictional example; you don't need to explain private circumstances.”

Choose the next step

- **Wants adaptation:** Offer a feasible in-session step; do not assume a shorter home task solves the barrier.
- **Declines public brainstorming:** Stop advice and honor the choice without labeling resistance.
- **Requests resources:** Use the actual support route and verify availability before promising anything.
- **Peers insist:** Restate the permission and privacy boundary. No debate, financial proof, or group vote.
- **Current harm or clinical change:** Pause for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the worksheet first or use coping to bypass an unsafe situation.

Return to Problem Solving

Resume after correcting the assumption and addressing current support needs. Use a separate seed-exchange labeling problem with real constraints. No personal housing, family, or financial disclosure is required.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended to find resources. Record the relevant barrier, actual choice, and confirmed or pending contact without peer histories. A written plan does not prove feasibility.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), emotion-regulation teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

A legitimate concern about the intervention

Scenario 26 | Adult IOP | DBT Check the Facts

Notice

Remy correctly identifies that the facilitator assumed a distortion before hearing the situation. Answer the criticism before defending the method.

First response

“You're right that I prejudged the example. That was an error in my framing. You don't need to explain your private situation to correct it.”

Choose the next step

- **Wants fiction:** Use a genuinely separate example, not a disguised personal account. Observation or passing remains available.
- **Requests review:** Explain the actual route and confirm responsibility; skill completion is not a condition.
- **Remains angry:** Hear the concern and state the next process briefly. Do not debate every accusation or demand reassurance.
- **Current harm or clinical change:** Take the report seriously; pause for support, local assessment, or emergency procedures. Do not argue harm away or finish the worksheet first.

Return to Check the Facts

Resume after correcting the framing and responding to review or clinical needs. Use a separate ferry-timetable example. Checking information can confirm that a concern is accurate; it does not presume the member is wrong.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, stay with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Record the relevant facilitator action, individual response, and actual or pending review without peer identities. An apology does not establish repair.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), emotion-regulation teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

The facilitator applies a boundary inconsistently

Scenario 27 | Adult IOP | DBT DEAR MAN

Notice

The facilitator checks a personal notification after asking members to put phones away. Logan's objection identifies a real inconsistency.

First response

“You're right. I checked a personal notification while you were speaking. That was inconsistent. I'm putting it away.”

Choose the next step

- **Wants to continue:** Return the turn without demanding acceptance, gratitude, or reassurance.
- **Reports a pattern:** Hear a brief concern and explain the actual review route. Do not debate each earlier event.
- **Peers defend staff:** Stop the pressure; members do not need to defend or forgive you.
- **Private exceptions questioned:** Explain the general request process without identifying another person's arrangements.
- **Urgent harm or clinical change:** Pause for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the worksheet first.

Return to DEAR MAN

Resume after correcting the behavior and addressing current review or clinical needs. Use a separate history-club request for advance slides. A complaint need not follow a skill formula before it is heard, and Logan need not rehearse it publicly.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, stay with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Record the relevant facilitator action, individual response, and confirmed or pending review without peer histories. Continued participation does not establish repaired trust.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), interpersonal-effectiveness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Staff give conflicting directions

Scenario 28 | Adult PHP | DBT Effectively

Notice

One facilitator permits fiction or observation; another requires personal disclosure. Ren asks which instruction applies. Staff must clarify the task.

First response

“You heard two different instructions. That confusion is ours to clarify. We're pausing the task.”

Choose the next step

- **Agreement possible:** State one coordinated instruction, participation choices, and the lead voice. Do not pretend the directions were identical.
- **Disagreement continues:** Keep the exercise paused and use the staff clarification route. No public status debate or member vote.
- **Disclosure concern:** Do not require private material to settle the conflict. Clarify this task without broad promises about program consequences.
- **Clinical concern identified:** Stop for local assessment or emergency procedures as indicated. Do not finish the worksheet or treat optional practice as a substitute for clinical response.

Return to Effectively

Resume only after roles and instructions are usable and current needs are addressed. Use a separate display-table teamwork example. Members do not portray staff or mediate the real disagreement.

Support and record

With two facilitators, confirm who covers the room before separate coordination; never both leave. Alone, remain with the group and request clarification or assistance; never leave it unattended or send peers to arbitrate. Record the individual's question, actual clarification, and pending decisions without peer histories. Confusion is not treatment refusal.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), mindfulness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

A member leaves during tension

Scenario 29 | Adult IOP | DBT STOP

Notice

Jamie leaves; destination and staff contact are unknown. No explicit threat was stated. Do not infer safety or dangerousness from departure alone.

First response

Pause teaching and activate the established departure/support route promptly.

“Please stay with me while I coordinate staff support. Peers don't need to follow.”

Choose the next step

- **Alone:** Remain with the group; never leave it unattended to search. Communicate observations and last known location to staff.
- **Co-facilitator present:** Explicitly allocate room coverage and the departure response. Never both follow.
- **No response:** Use the backup or escalation route; an unanswered message is not a handoff.
- **Contact confirmed:** Clarify accepted responsibility and needed next actions. Contact does not establish assessment or readiness to return.
- **Known urgent risk, possible immediate harm, or clinical change:** Activate local assessment or emergency procedures without waiting for a return or finishing the worksheet.

Return to STOP

Resume only when response responsibility and current clinical needs permit, with coverage maintained. Otherwise keep teaching paused and escalate. Use a separate cabinet-painting frustration. A step back can occur in place; it does not require leaving.

Support and record

No peer search, private-history explanation, or public motive debate. Do not improvise physical blocking. Record observed statements, actual contacts, and unresolved status without declaring safety or disposition that was not assessed.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), distress-tolerance teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Returning after individual support

Scenario 30 | Adult PHP | DBT Describe

Notice

Micah returns with staff; peers ask for details and an apology. Physical return does not establish an accepted care arrangement.

First response

“You don't need to explain the individual conversation. We're pausing while staff confirm the return arrangement.”

Choose the next step

- **Plan confirmed:** Clarify accepted responsibility, necessary support, and feasible participation choices through the appropriate channel.
- **Plan unclear:** Keep teaching paused and seek clarification. A member's “I'm fine” is not the handoff.
- **Peers demand repair:** Stop intrusive questions and compulsory apology or forgiveness. Offer appropriate concern and support routes without debating private care.
- **Conduct resumes:** Apply the current boundary and local response.
- **New clinical change or urgent harm:** Stop for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish a worksheet or require grounding first.

Return to Describe

Resume only after coordination and current needs permit. Use a separate market-stall layout, with accessible description. Do not make Micah's behavior the example or use practice as a readiness test.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, allocate coverage and coordination explicitly. Alone, stay with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended for a handoff conversation. Record the actual plan, role acceptance, and observed choice without peer histories. Quietness or an apology does not establish safety or repair.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), mindfulness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

A disruption recurs across sessions

Scenario 31 | Adult IOP | DBT Problem Solving

Notice

Kai repeatedly gives advice during others' turns. Address this instance and arrange review of the pattern; do not diagnose intent.

First response

“Kai, please hold the idea while the speaker finishes. The speaker keeps the turn.”

Choose the next step

- **Stops:** Restore the turn. Offer an accessible way to hold an idea without promising time for every suggestion.
- **Pattern persists:** Arrange private review of observations, instructions, barriers, and the member's account. Agree on a feasible cue, alternative, and review point.
- **Current disruption continues:** Pause teaching and request staff support; no public argument or improvised punishment.
- **Peers complain:** Hear the effect on participation without recruiting monitors or disclosing an individual plan.
- **Urgent harm or clinical change:** Stop for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish the worksheet or require cue-following first.

Return to Problem Solving

Resume after protecting the current turn and addressing immediate needs. Use a separate repair-café tool-tracking problem. Members do not analyze Kai or design consequences. A trial and review point do not guarantee resolution.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, coordinate support and coverage. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended for individual review. No compulsory private-history explanation. Record actual behavior, the agreed cue if one exists, response, and pending review without peer identities or character labels.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), emotion-regulation teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

Ending while tension remains

Scenario 32 | Adult PHP | DBT STOP

Notice

Four teaching minutes remain. Emery says the concern is unresolved. The lesson can end while necessary care and coverage continue.

First response

“Ending the lesson doesn't mean the concern is resolved. I'll explain the next process and confirm the support arrangement.”

Choose the next step

- **Nonurgent follow-up accepted:** Confirm the receiving person and next step. Do not promise agreement or resolution.
- **Contact unconfirmed:** Maintain coverage, continue coordination, and use the backup/escalation route. Do not abandon responsibility at the scheduled endpoint.
- **Debate restarts:** State the limit briefly; no compulsory apology, forgiveness, private disclosure, or positive takeaway.
- **Appointment or transport transition:** Coordinate actual arrangements through local procedures; this card does not authorize detention or release.
- **Urgent harm or clinical change:** Stop routine closure for local assessment or emergency procedures. Do not finish a worksheet, require a skill, or wait for unaccepted handoff first.

Closing STOP reminder

Offer only if current care and transition responsibilities permit; otherwise omit it. Use a separate mislabeled-photo-album example. A step back can occur in place. The reminder is not a readiness or discharge test.

Support and record

With a co-facilitator, allocate coverage and coordination. Alone, remain with the group and request assistance; never leave it unattended. Record actual concerns, accepted or pending responsibility, and subsequent actions without peer histories or unsupported safety conclusions.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), distress-tolerance teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

A member says they plan to end their life

Scenario 33 | Adult IOP | DBT Self-Soothe

Notice

Kendall describes an intention, a time frame, and a method. Stop the lesson. An apology or “I was joking” does not lower the urgency.

First response

“Kendall, thank you for telling me. I'm taking this seriously, and I'm getting a clinician here now. I'd like you to stay with me until they arrive.”

Choose the next step

- **Urgent risk statement:** Request a clinician now with Kendall's exact words. Stay with Kendall and the group. If nobody answers, use the backup route.
- **Takes it back:** “Whenever anyone says something like that, a clinician checks in the same day.” Do not argue.
- **Stands to leave:** Ask them to stay; do not block or follow. Tell staff the direction, words, and description. Follow your emergency procedure.
- **Says they already took something:** Medical emergency. Use your emergency procedure now.
- **Peers react:** “Kendall is getting support now. Tell me if you'd like to talk with staff today.”

Return to Self-Soothe

Only after a clinician has accepted responsibility and the group is covered. Ending or shortening the session is acceptable. If you continue, use a brief, optional fictional example and close with how to reach staff today.

Support and record

Never leave the group unattended or send a member for help. Do not ask about the plan in front of others or promise secrecy. Quote the statement exactly; record times, who accepted responsibility, and actions taken. In the United States, 988 (call or text) is available 24/7.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), distress-tolerance teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

A member appears intoxicated

Scenario 34 | Adult PHP | DBT Observe

Notice

Rowan arrives with slurred speech, unsteady walking, and a smell of alcohol. Medical safety comes before rules. Other causes are possible.

First response

“Rowan, I'm glad you came in. You seem unsteady, and I want a clinician to check on you. I'm calling them now.”

Choose the next step

- **Accepts help:** Report observations, not conclusions. Keep Rowan where you can see them.
- **Loud or argumentative:** Do not debate. Keep your distance. “I'm getting someone to check on you.” Do not block the door.
- **Drowsy, hard to rouse, vomiting, or slow breathing:** Medical emergency. Use your emergency procedure now; do not leave Rowan alone.
- **Mentions driving:** Tell responding staff immediately; transport decisions follow program procedure.
- **Peers comment:** “We'll keep the focus on our own work. Staff are helping.”

Return to Observe

Only after a clinician has accepted responsibility. Use a neutral object, such as a glass of water. Do not refer to Rowan or the interruption.

Support and record

Never leave the group unattended or send a member for help. Record observed signs, Rowan's words, times, who accepted responsibility, and any mention of driving. Do not record a diagnosis.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), mindfulness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

A member threatens another member

Scenario 35 | Adult IOP | DBT STOP

Notice

Cameron threatens Jules and steps toward them. This is a safety situation. Stop the lesson.

First response

“Cameron, I can see you're really angry. I need you to step back and sit down. I'm getting someone to help.”

Choose the next step

- **Sits down:** Thank him briefly. Request help anyway. Keep Cameron and Jules apart.
- **Continues or moves closer:** Use your emergency procedure or panic alert now. Move others away calmly. Do not step between people or touch anyone.
- **Physical aggression or weapon:** Emergency. Follow your procedure, including 911 if that is the local instruction. Help others leave if safe.
- **Jules wants to leave:** Support it and tell staff.
- **Peers join in:** “Everyone, please stay seated and quiet while staff come.”

Return to STOP

Only after staff have taken over and the room is safe. Ending early is often right. Use a fictional traffic example; do not refer to Cameron or Jules.

Support and record

Keep exits clear. Never restrain or block anyone. Quote the threat exactly, record times and responders, and tell your supervisor the same day; duty-to-warn laws vary by state.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), distress-tolerance teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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Standalone quick reference

A virtual member hints at danger, then disconnects

Scenario 36 | Adult IOP | DBT STOP

Notice

Peyton says, “I'm not sure I'll still be here tomorrow,” then leaves the meeting. Treat it as urgent until you know otherwise.

First response

“Peyton left the meeting, and I want to make sure they're okay. I'm going to call them and let staff know. Please stay with me.”

Choose the next step

- **You reach Peyton:** Say you heard what they said and that a clinician will talk with them. Alert staff with their words and location.
- **No answer:** Alert staff now with Peyton's words, the time, and the confirmed location. Follow the emergency procedure.
- **Peyton rejoins:** Welcome them; arrange a private clinician contact. Do not assess in front of the group.
- **Members want to help:** “Please don't message Peyton. Staff are handling it.”

Return to STOP

Only after staff have taken responsibility. Use a fictional dropped-call example; do not refer to Peyton.

Support and record

Stay in the meeting with your camera on. Confirm location and a backup number at the start of every virtual session. Quote statements exactly and record times and who took responsibility.

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Standalone quick reference

Someone else is in a virtual member's room

Scenario 37 | Adult IOP | DBT Describe

Notice

Another person is heard in Hayden's room. Other members' privacy and Hayden's possible safety are both at stake.

First response

“Let's pause for a moment. Hayden, it sounds like someone else is near you. Could you use headphones or move somewhere more private?”

Choose the next step

- **Moves or uses headphones:** Check the space, then return the turn to the member who was sharing.
- **Can't get privacy:** Offer listening with microphone muted or a later check-in. Keep sharing to fictional examples.
- **May not be safe:** Private message: “Are you safe to talk right now? Reply yes or no, or use our safe word.” Alert staff with Hayden's location if not safe.
- **The other person speaks:** “This group is for members only.” Mute Hayden's audio if possible.

Return to Describe

Only after privacy is restored. Use a fictional photo of a kitchen counter; describe without guessing.

Support and record

Never ask about the other person in front of the group. Confirm a safe word and privacy expectations at the start of each session. Record observations and actions.

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Standalone quick reference

A member joins while driving

Scenario 38 | Adult IOP | DBT One Mindfully

Notice

Charlie joins from a moving car. Safety and privacy come first.

First response

“Charlie, thanks for making the effort to join. For your safety, please leave now and rejoin when you're parked or not driving.”

Choose the next step

- **Leaves and rejoins:** Welcome them back. Follow the attendance policy.
- **Stays on:** Repeat once, then remove them from the meeting if possible. Message: “Please rejoin when parked.”
- **No other option:** Refer the barrier to the treatment team. Do not continue while they drive.
- **Camera off, no response:** Private check-in message. If safety is a concern, follow Scenario 36.
- **Members comment:** “Charlie will rejoin when it's safe. Let's continue.”

Return to One Mindfully

Use a fictional person cooking while checking a phone, then focusing on one task. Do not refer to Charlie.

Support and record

Follow your program's attendance and telehealth policies. Record times, requests, and actions.

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Standalone quick reference

A private chat message asks you to keep a secret

Scenario 39 | Adult IOP | DBT Validation

Notice

Brooke privately writes, “I don't feel safe at home right now. Please don't tell anyone.” Find out if Brooke is in danger now.

First response

Private chat: “Thank you for telling me. Are you in danger right now? Reply yes or no.”

Choose the next step

- **Yes, in danger now:** Alert staff now with the location and message. Follow the emergency procedure. Keep messages short.
- **No, not right now:** Ask permission for a staff call today. Alert staff and tell Brooke who will call.
- **Asks for secrecy:** “I can't promise that, because your safety matters. I'll only share what's needed to help you.”
- **Leaves or stops replying:** Follow Scenario 36. Alert staff with the location.

Return to Validation

Only after staff are alerted. Use a fictional friend who is tired from moving. Do not refer to Brooke.

Support and record

Never read private messages aloud. Never promise secrecy. Quote the message exactly; record times and who was notified.

Skill source: Linehan (2015), interpersonal-effectiveness teaching notes. Guilford teaching notes

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